



# Ismail Ahmad

## Senior Product Designer

Berlin, Germany • Remote • [Work VISA available](#)

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### Summary

10+ years designing financial products used by millions across Africa, Europe, and the US. I specialise in the intersection of product strategy and design, building the teams, systems, and operations that turn complex, regulated product into clear, trustworthy experiences. My contribution has earned recognition at the Red Dot Design Awards, iF Awards, and MENA Design Awards etc. Currently leading a full product transformation at Sterling Bank.

[read more ismailahmad.com](#)

### Professional Experience

#### Sterling Bank

June 2025 - Present  
Remote

#### Head of Design, Contract

- Hired back to lead a complete product overhaul, rebuilding Sterling's digital banking platform from the ground up while simultaneously standing up the design team and function.
- Established design operations, creating the frameworks and processes for a scalable, sustainable design practice.
- Designing and ship core banking features including savings accounts, card management, loans, and budgeting tools that redefine Sterling's digital offering for millions of users.

#### Cadara Studio

Mar 2019 - Present  
Berlin, Remote

#### Design Consultant, Self Employed

- Independent design consultancy at the intersection of product strategy, experience design, and brand. Clients include fintech startups and enterprise banks across Europe and Africa.
- Partner with founders and product teams to solve business challenges through systematic design, from early-stage product definition to scaling design operations.

#### Accenture Song

Mar 2023 - Sept 2024  
Berlin, Full Time

#### Senior UX Designer

- Designed Motel One's digital check-in and mobile key experience, bagging Red Dot Silver Award winner, driving measurable lifts in store reviews and guest satisfaction ratings across channel.
- Redesigned a credit platform that directly increased credit contract volume and business activity in the UAE.
- Conduct internal audits and competitive benchmarking for renown banks in Germany, Deutsche Bank's in-house operations software, delivering improvements to operational efficiency and cross-team collaboration.

### Education

**BSc Business and Management**  
University Of Europe  
Sept 2024\*

### Professional Certifications

**UX Design Professional Diploma**  
Glasgow University / UXDI

**Interaction Design Diploma**  
Digital Product School Munich

### Core Competencies

Product Design, Design Systems, UX/UI, Product Strategy, Branding, Entrepreneurship, Leadership, Design Operations, Stakeholder Management, User Research, Usability Testing

### Technical Skills

#### Design:

Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator), Affinity Designer, Cursor

#### Prototyping:

Figma, Framer, HTML, CSS, Tailwinds, JavaScript (basic)

#### AI Tools:

Claude, ChatGPT, V0, Cursor, Midjourney; integrated into research, prototyping, and delivery workflows

### Language

|         |               |
|---------|---------------|
| English | Fluent C2     |
| German  | Elementary A2 |
| Yoruba  | Native        |

Previous experiences

Lemfi ↗

Sept 2021 - Sept 2023  
California, Remote

Senior Product Designer

- Led end-to-end design of core mobile features, digital cards, global savings accounts, and cross-border money transfers, for a platform serving users across the US, Europe, China, and Africa.
- Audited and redesigned critical compliance flows to meet international regulatory standards and prevent fraud across multiple jurisdictions.
- Collaborated with globally distributed engineering, product, and compliance teams to ship features at pace without compromising quality or regulatory integrity.

Sterling Bank ↗

Sept 2021 - Feb 2023  
Lagos, Nigeria

Product Design Lead

- Led product design for Gomoney Digital Bank, Sterling's consumer fintech product, managing a design team and owning the end-to-end user experience. We built design that reduce overload for the customer support team, saving the company resources.
- Managed design operations and collaborated directly with C-suite stakeholders on product roadmap, go-to-market strategy, and growth initiatives.
- Shaped the design culture and operational cadence that supported rapid iteration across multiple product streams.

Mezovest ↗

Mar 2020 - Sept 2021  
New York, Remote

Senior Designer

- Sole design lead working alongside the founder, owned end-to-end product design across commerce, logistics, and payments.
- Drove research, UX/UI, interaction design, core product architecture, and complete brand identity from zero to launch. From unknown to securing our first \$100K with trust under a year.

NCK Technology ↗

Jan 2017 - Feb 2020  
Lagos, Nigeria

Designer

- Designed custom banking and enterprise software for major Nigerian financial institutions including Fidelity Bank, Access Bank, and UBA. We overshoot our year turnover by over 280% margin.
- Led the design of EasyDispatch, a logistics platform tackling last-mile delivery challenges in Nigeria, the business turnover multi millions of naira in the first six months.
- Built and led a small design team delivering across multiple concurrent client engagements.

Awards & Recognition

Cross-platform work. International brands.  
Experiences recognised by the industry's leading design awards.



reddot design award

Brands I have worked with

